Mahesh Basavaraj

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The Selection Committee — Faculty Recruitment
UNSW Bengaluru
Embassy Manyata Business Park, Nagavara
Bengaluru 560045, Karnataka, India

Re: Application for Assistant Professor, Computer Science — UNSW Bengaluru Campus

Dear Members of the Selection Committee,

I am writing to apply for the position of Assistant Professor, Computer Science, at the UNSW Bengaluru campus. I am currently Assistant Professor in Computer Science & Engineering (Data Science) at Dayananda Sagar Academy of Technology & Management, Bengaluru, and a doctoral researcher at Visvesvaraya Technological University. My career spans sixteen years across the two worlds this campus sits between: eight years building enterprise and banking software at Infosys and Accenture, and eight years teaching computer science and publishing applied AI research in Bengaluru.

Teaching is the part of my work I have invested in most deliberately. At DSATM I designed and led a six-month Agentic AI immersion programme for students in partnership with Capabl, and I run faculty development programmes for colleagues. I have taught object-oriented programming, data structures, operating systems, database systems and deep learning to undergraduate and postgraduate students, and I supervise final-year capstone projects end to end. My approach is constructionist: students should build systems and watch them behave, not memorise definitions. To make that possible at scale I build my own teaching tools — an interactive Socratic game in which students predict operating-system scheduling, paging and deadlock behaviour and are graded on every decision; a progressive, scored decision track for learning data structures; and classroom CI/CD projects where every push is tested and gated. These are public on GitHub and in daily classroom use. I am ready to adopt UNSW's myExperience design framework and the Integrated Curriculum Framework, to work within standards-based, criterion-referenced assessment, and to complete the Ready to Teach programme alongside colleagues from Kensington.

My research is in Agentic AI, large language models and spatio-temporal deep learning. I hold three utility patents — in adaptive quality of service for heterogeneous IoT networks, ethical AI and bias mitigation, and machine-assisted agricultural automation — together with a published patent application in synchronised social-VR IoT networks, and more than ten peer-reviewed papers, including recent work on multi-scale spatio-temporal networks with frequency–spatial parallel attention, lightweight multi-agent Q-learning for wireless IoT, and LLM-based agent systems as a route to general intelligence. The campus's focus on artificial intelligence, and its Centre of Excellence in AI and Innovation with Deloitte India, is precisely where I want to work: applied, industry-connected research that produces both publications and capability.

Eight years in industry also taught me what employers expect from a computer science graduate, and how to build that expectation into assessment. At Infosys I worked on Finacle, the universal banking platform; at Accenture I built capital-markets systems for international clients. I can bring those networks and that experience into work-integrated learning — authentic industry projects, internship pipelines, and assessment built around real repositories, code review and delivery discipline.

What draws me to UNSW Bengaluru specifically is a top-20 global degree with local consequence. Progress for All is a mission I can teach to, and the chance to help establish the standards of a new campus rather than inherit them is rare. I am based in Bengaluru and ready to contribute from the first teaching period.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role, and I am glad to deliver a teaching demonstration on any topic in the computer science curriculum.

Yours sincerely,

Mahesh Basavaraj
Assistant Professor, CSE (Data Science) · DSATM, Bengaluru

ENCLOSURES: Curriculum Vitae · Research Publications & Patents · Teaching Methodology